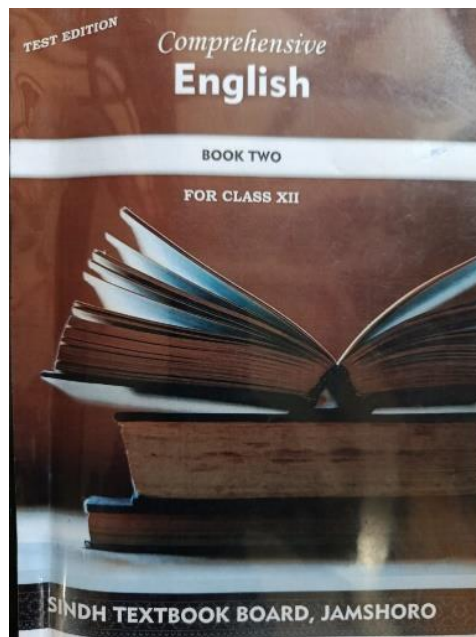


English  
Book Two  
For the class XII



## Icarus and Daedalus by Josephine Preston Peabody



### Josephine Preston Peabody at a glance

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name</b>                 | Josephine Preston Peabody                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Born &amp; died</b>      | 1874 – 1922                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Place of birth</b>       | USA                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Profession</b>           | Poet and playwright                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Literary period</b>      | late Victorian and early Modernist eras                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Notable works</b>        | The Singing Man, a collection of poems exhibiting Peabody's growing concern with social injustice, the Wings (1907), a verse drama                                                                                          |
| <b>Awards / Distinction</b> | Josephine Preston Peabody's primary distinction was winning the <b>Stratford-on-Avon Prize</b> (also known as the Stratford Play Competition or Shakespeare Memorial Prize) in 1909 for her verse drama, <i>The Piper</i> . |
| <b>Main theme</b>           | excessive pride and ignoring limits                                                                                                                                                                                         |

### Short Question-Answers

**Q-1** How does the story reflect the dangers of unchecked ambition?

**Ans-** Daedalus was a very clever man who built the Labyrinth for King Minos, but later the king imprisoned him and his son Icarus. To escape the island, Daedalus made wings from feathers and wax. He warned Icarus not to fly too high or too low. During the flight, Icarus became careless and flew too close to the sun. The heat melted the wax, his wings broke, and he fell into the sea and died.

**Q-2** Compare and contrast Daedalus and Icarus?

**Ans-** Daedalus and Icarus were very different in nature. Daedalus was wise, careful, and experienced. He planned their escape thoughtfully and warned his son about danger. He respected limits and believed in caution. Icarus, on the other hand, was young, excited, and careless. He

ignored his father's advice and flew too high out of joy and pride. While Daedalus valued safety and wisdom, Icarus valued freedom and thrill, which led to his tragic fall.

**Q-3** What is the significance of Daedalus dedicating his wings to Appollo after Icarus' fall?

**Ans-** By dedicating his wings to Apollo, Daedalus shows deep grief, regret, and humility. The wings remind him of his son's death and his own responsibility. Offering them to the god means he is giving up his pride and ambition. It also shows respect for the gods and acceptance of human limits. Daedalus learns that going beyond natural boundaries can bring loss, so he never tries to fly again.

**Q-4** What moral lesson can be drawn from the story? Provide examples from the text to justify each lesson.

**Ans-** One lesson is obedience to wise advice. Icarus ignores his father's warning and flies too close to the sun, leading to his death.

Another lesson is the danger of excessive pride and ambition. Icarus is blinded by joy and forgets all caution.

A third lesson is knowing one's limits. Daedalus survives because he respects balance, while Icarus falls because he crosses it.

**Q. No-5-**Did Daedalus foresee Icarus' fall when he warned him about flying too high or too low? Justify your response with evidence from the text.

**Ans-** Yes, Daedalus partly foresaw the danger. He clearly warned Icarus "never to fly very low or very high" and explained that the sun would melt the wax. This shows that he understood the risks and predicted what could happen if the warning was ignored. However, he did not expect Icarus to disobey so completely. His warnings prove foresight, but his grief shows he did not imagine the tragedy would truly happen.

Below are clear meanings and common synonyms for each word / phrase, written in simple, exam-friendly language:

- Aloft — up in the air  
*Synonyms:* airborne, high up
- Apollo — a Greek god of the sun, music, and knowledge  
*Synonyms:* sun god
- At length — after a long time  
*Synonyms:* finally, eventually
- Captive — kept as a prisoner  
*Synonyms:* imprisoned, confined

- Cautions — warnings to be careful  
*Synonyms:* warnings, advice
- Cleave — to cut or move through  
*Synonyms:* split, slice
- Cunning — clever and skillful  
*Synonyms:* intelligent, crafty
- Cupid — the Roman god of love  
*Synonyms:* love god
- Daze — to confuse or stun  
*Synonyms:* confuse, bewilder
- Draught — a small amount taken in one drink  
*Synonyms:* sip, swallow
- Drooped — bent or hung down  
*Synonyms:* sagged, wilted
- Fasten — to attach firmly  
*Synonyms:* tie, fix
- Fledgling — young or inexperienced  
*Synonyms:* beginner, novice
- Halcyon-bird — a calm, peaceful sea bird  
*Synonyms:* kingfisher (symbolic)
- Labyrinth — a complex maze  
*Synonyms:* maze, puzzle
- Long for — to strongly desire  
*Synonyms:* wish for, yearn for
- Mortals — human beings  
*Synonyms:* humans, people
- Mould — to shape or form  
*Synonyms:* shape, fashion
- Quench — to satisfy or put out  
*Synonyms:* satisfy, extinguish
- Rash — careless and hasty  
*Synonyms:* reckless, impulsive

- Seagulls — sea birds found near water  
*Synonyms:* gulls
- Snowflakes — small pieces of falling snow  
*Synonyms:* flakes of snow
- Tangled — twisted and confused  
*Synonyms:* knotted, mixed
- Toss — to throw lightly  
*Synonyms:* fling, throw
- Vainly — without success  
*Synonyms:* uselessly, fruitlessly
- Veer — to change direction  
*Synonyms:* turn, shift
- Wavered — moved unsteadily  
*Synonyms:* shook, trembled
- Winnow — to move air or separate  
*Synonyms:* fan, sift

## 15 MCQs based on the essay “Conquest of Happiness”:

- 1- Why was Daedalus imprisoned by King Minos?
  - A. He tried to escape Crete
  - B. He revealed secrets of the gods
  - C. The king’s favor changed
  - D. He destroyed the Labyrinth
- 2- What made the Labyrinth impossible to escape?
  - A. Its great height
  - B. Magical walls
  - C. Its tangled and winding paths
  - D. Guarded soldiers
- 3- Why was escaping by ship impossible for Daedalus?
  - A. The sea was dangerous
  - B. Ships were forbidden
  - C. All ships were guarded
  - D. He could not swim
- 4- What inspired Daedalus to invent wings?
  - A. Clouds in the sky

- B. Birds flying freely
  - C. Dreams of escape
  - D. Stories of the gods
- 5- What materials were used to make the wings?
- A. Cloth and rope
  - B. Wood and iron
  - C. Feathers and wax
  - D. Leather and glue
- 6- What warning did Daedalus give Icarus before flying?
- A. Do not fly too fast
  - B. Do not fly at night
  - C. Do not fly too low or too high
  - D. Do not look down
- 7- Why did Icarus ignore his father's advice?
- A. He did not hear it
  - B. He trusted his wings
  - C. He was overcome with joy
  - D. He wanted to disobey
- 8- How did people on the ground react when they saw them flying?
- A. They were frightened
  - B. They ran away
  - C. They thought they were gods
  - D. They tried to help
- 9- What feeling replaced fear once Icarus was in the air?
- A. Pride
  - B. Joy
  - C. Anger
  - D. Confidence
- 10- What caused Icarus to fall from the sky?
- A. Strong winds
  - B. Broken feathers
  - C. Melted wax
  - D. Fatigue
- 11- Which god is mentioned by the people who saw the flyers?
- A. Zeus
  - B. Apollo
  - C. Hermes
  - D. Ares
- 12- What happened to the feathers after Icarus fell?
- A. They burned

- B. They vanished
  - C. They floated on water
  - D. They sank immediately
- 13- How did Daedalus honor Icarus after his death?
- A. By building a statue
  - B. By naming an island
  - C. By writing a song
  - D. By returning to Crete
- 14- Why did Daedalus hang his wings in Apollo's temple?
- A. To celebrate success
  - B. To thank the god
  - C. As a sign of grief and repentance
  - D. To teach others to fly
- 15- What did Daedalus decide never to do again after Icarus' death?
- A. Build inventions
  - B. Serve kings
  - C. Travel by sea
  - D. Attempt to fly

## **Answer Key with Justifications**

### **1. Correct Answer: b) Daedalus**

Daedalus is described as "more cunning than all other mortals" and skilled enough to learn the secrets of the gods.

### **2. Correct Answer: c) King Minos**

The Labyrinth was built for King Minos of Crete.

### **3. Correct Answer: c) A Labyrinth**

The king imprisoned Daedalus after the Labyrinth was built.

### **4. Correct Answer: c) Feathers and wax**

Daedalus gathered feathers and moulded them together with wax to make wings.

### **5. Correct Answer: b) Seagulls**

Daedalus got the idea of flying by watching seagulls freely moving in the air.

### **6. Correct Answer: c) Not fly too high or too low**

Daedalus warned Icarus against both extremes to avoid danger.

### **7. Correct Answer: b) The wax would melt**

Flying too near the sun would melt the wax holding the feathers.

**8. Correct Answer: c) He became overjoyed and careless**

Icarus forgot his father's warnings due to excitement and joy.

**9. Correct Answer: c) He flew too close to the sun**

Icarus ignored caution and moved toward the highest heavens.

**10. Correct Answer: c) The wax melted**

The heat of the sun melted the wax, causing the feathers to fall.

**11. Correct Answer: b) He drowned in the sea**

Icarus fell helplessly into the sea and drowned.

**12. Correct Answer: b) Icaria**

Daedalus named the nearest island Icaria in memory of his son.

**13. Correct Answer: c) Appollo**

Daedalus dedicated his wings at the temple of Appollo in Sicily.

**14. Correct Answer: c) He stopped flying forever**

Out of grief and regret, Daedalus never attempted to fly again.

**15. Correct Answer: b) Rash ambition leads to destruction**

The story highlights that ignoring wise advice and acting rashly leads to tragic consequences, as seen in Icarus' fall.

## Essay

**Brainstorming Points for “Self-Discipline”**

- What self-discipline is
- Control over desires and habits
- Importance in daily life
- Role in success and character building
- Examples from students' life
- Long-term benefits of self-discipline



## Self-Discipline

Self-discipline means the ability to control one's actions, emotions, and habits in order to achieve a goal. It helps a person choose what is right instead of what is easy. A disciplined person works according to rules and does not depend on mood or comfort.

It plays a very important role in life. Without it, talent and intelligence often go to waste. Many people know what is good for them, but they fail because they cannot control their laziness or distractions. Self-discipline gives strength to continue working even when motivation is low.

For students, self-discipline is the key to success. Regular study, proper time management, and avoidance of bad habits help students perform well in exams. A student who studies daily for a short time often achieves more than one who studies only at the last moment.

self-control also builds strong character. It teaches patience, honesty, and responsibility. A disciplined person keeps promises, respects time, and remains focused on long-term goals. Such qualities are essential for leadership and personal growth.

In daily life, self-discipline improves health and peace of mind. Regular exercise, healthy eating, and controlled use of mobile phones are simple examples. These habits protect a person from stress and regret.

Self-mastery is the foundation of success and happiness. It turns dreams into reality and weak desires into strong actions. A disciplined life may seem difficult at first, but it leads to freedom, confidence, and lasting achievement.

**“Self-discipline is choosing between what you want now and what you want most.” —**  
*Abraham Lincoln*

